

The old rulers are gone. What remains are heirs, siblings, tutors, and guards — all too young to rule alone, yet powerful together. Victory does not come from domination, but from careful movement, cooperation, and the fall of a single Prince.

Welcome to ***Heirs***.

Game rules

Heirs is a two-player board game on a 12x12 board. Each player is assigned a color, Black or White. White always gets the opening (first) move. The game pieces and initial board state are as follows:



Baby



Prince



Princess



Pony



Guard



Tutor



Scout



Sibling

12												
11												
10												
9												
8												
7												
6												
5												
4												
3												
2												
1												
	a	b	c	d	e	f	g	h	j	k	m	n

Pay particular attention to the letters that designate the columns: both “i” and lowercase “l” are skipped to eliminate possible ambiguities. Your code must account for this.

General Rules and Pieces

1. Overview

Heirs is a two-player strategy board game played on a 12×12 board. Each player controls a youthful royal household. The goal is simple: **capture your opponent's Prince**.

There are no special-case rules, no hidden exceptions. This is unlike other board games you may know (e.g., promoting a piece that reaches the opposite end of the board – this does not happen in Heirs).

2. Components

- 12×12 square board
- 24 pieces per player (Black and White)

3. Setup

Each player places:

- **12 Babies** on the front row
- **12 Major Pieces** on the back row

As shown above.

White moves first.

4. Turn Structure

- Players alternate turns
- On your turn, move exactly one piece
- Captures occur by moving onto an occupied enemy square

5. Winning the Game

The game ends immediately when a **Prince** is captured (more details on game over rules later).

6. Piece Guide & Movement

All descriptions and figures below are from the perspective of the White player, which starts with its pieces at the bottom of the board. When we say "forward" below, this means up for the White player (and, conversely, down for the Black player). The graphics shown below should be flipped vertically for the Black player.

Baby (12 per side) - We have all been one of them

- Moves 1 or 2 squares straight forward per turn.
- May choose either distance every turn.
- Cannot move backward.
- Cannot jump over pieces.
- Captures straight forward.

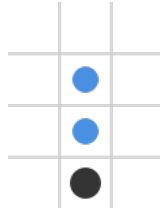


Figure 1: Baby movement. Current location of a White baby is shown as the black disk. The blue disks represent allowed positions that this Baby may move to.

Prince (1 per side) - The most important piece

- Moves 1 square in any direction.
- If captured, the game ends.
- It is ok for the Prince to be in the line of capture of opponent pieces: the Prince is, in principle, not obligated to move away. The only thing that matters in the end is whether the Prince is captured. Of course, if a Prince is in the line of capture of an opponent piece and does nothing about it, likely that Prince will lose the game on the next turn...

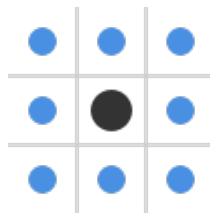


Figure 2: Prince

Princess (1 per side) - Short-range ruler

- Moves 1 - 3 steps in any direction.
- Cannot jump over pieces.

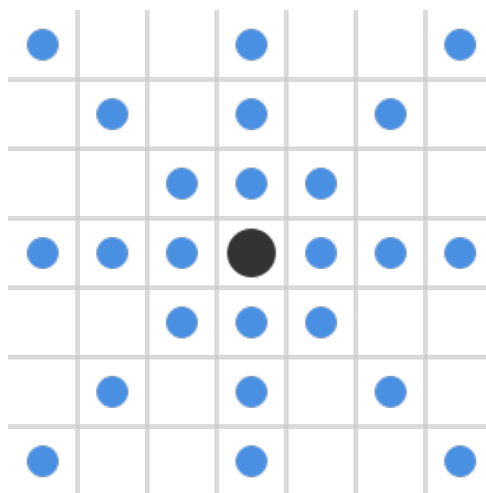


Figure 3: Princess

Pony (2 per side) - Short-leaping attacker

- Moves exactly one step in any diagonal direction.

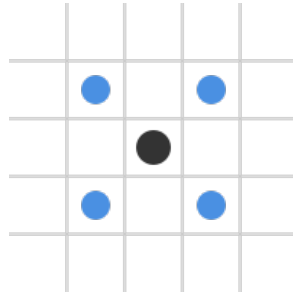


Figure 4: Pony

Guard (2 per side) - Straight-line attacker

- Moves up to 2 squares horizontally or vertically.
- Cannot jump over pieces.

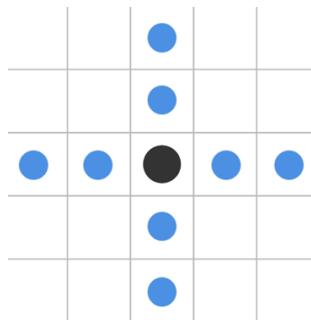


Figure 5: Guard

Tutor (2 per side) - Careful diagonal guide

- Moves up to 2 squares diagonally.
- Cannot jump over pieces.

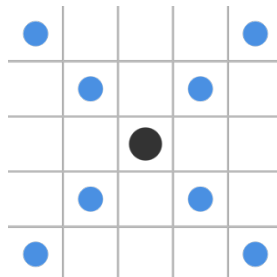


Figure 6: Tutor

Scout (2 per side) - Forward-focused striker

- Moves 1 - 3 squares forward; may also shift by 1 sideways while advancing.
- Jumps over pieces allowed.
- At most one capture may occur, on the landing point, and with no further movement allowed.

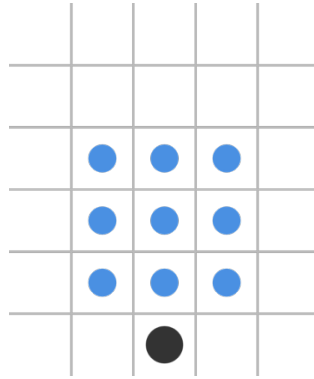


Figure 7: Scout

Sibling (2 per side) - Cooperative fighter

- Moves 1 step in any direction, but must end adjacent (in any of the possible 8 directions) to at least one friendly piece.

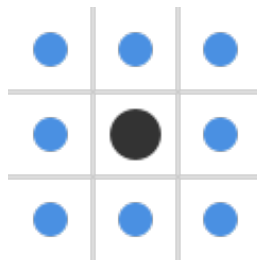


Figure 8: Sibling movement, but a destination location is only allowed if it is adjacent (horizontally, vertically, or diagonally) to one or more existing friendly pieces.

7. Quick Reference Sheet

Piece Summary and Notations Used For Programming

White Piece and Black Piece below denotes the symbol we will use in the board to represent each piece. Blank grid cells in the board will be represented by a dot ".", as further shown below. Generally speaking, White pieces are represented by capital letters, and Black pieces by lowercase letters.

Piece	Move	White Piece	Black Piece
Baby	1-2 forward	B	b
Prince	1 any direction	P	p
Princess	1-3 any direction	X	x
Pony	1 diagonal	Y	y
Guard	1-2 orthogonal	G	g
Tutor	1-2 diagonal	T	t
Scout	1-3 forward (+1 sideways)	S	s
Sibling	1 any direction, adjacent ally required	N	n

Design Philosophy

- Large board, short moves
- Youthful hierarchy
- No special-case rules
- Tactical positioning over raw power

Designer Balance Notes

- The 12x12 board increases spatial tension while shorter movement limits power.
- Babies advancing up to 2 squares maintains tempo without first-move exceptions.
- However, babies advancing too fast may get stuck on the other end of the board and will become useless.
- Princess is deliberately capped at 3 to avoid dominance.
- Pony jump range keeps tactical surprise without board-wide threats.
- Sibling encourages formation play and discourages lone attacks.
- No check/checkmate reduces rules overhead and encourages bold play.

Enjoy **Heirs**.